

TYSON'S TIME

# THE FIRST 30 DAYS KIT

A calm, practical adjustment plan for your rescue dog's first month home.



Built from one rescue's real first month.

TYSON'S TIME

# Welcome home.

When Tyson came home, he didn't need a perfect system. He needed to feel safe. What finally worked wasn't a trick — it was a rhythm: same walk, same words, same calm, every single day. This kit is that rhythm, organized so you can use it from day one.

## How to use this kit

- **Read the Roadmap first** (next page). It gives you the shape of the month in two minutes.
- **Print the trackers and checklists** — or keep the PDF on your phone and fill things in anywhere.
- **Take it one day at a time.** Nothing in here is a test. Skipped a day? Just pick the rhythm back up.

**What this is:** a practical organization and adjustment resource — routines, checklists, and trackers for your dog's first month home.

**What this is not:** veterinary care, medical advice, or professional behavior treatment. For health concerns or concerning behavior, bring in your veterinarian or a qualified trainer — page 11 helps you prepare for exactly those conversations.

## What's inside

- 3 — The 30-Day Roadmap
- 4 — Decompression & Adjustment Schedule
- 5 — Daily Rhythm Builder
- 6 — 30-Day Consistency Tracker
- 7 — Home Preparation Checklist
- 8 — First Night Checklist
- 9 — Ten Trust-Building Activities
- 10 — Observation Log
- 11 — Questions for Your Vet & Trainer
- 12 — Household Rules & Responsibilities
- 13 — Weekly Progress Tracker
- 14 — Emergency & Important Contacts
- 15 — Disclaimer & About

# The 30-Day Roadmap

One month, four focuses. Days are approximate — your dog sets the pace.

## Week 1 • Decompress (Days 1–7)

**Focus:** safety and predictability. Small world: one calm room, short leashed potty trips, no visitors, no big outings.

**A win looks like:** eating, drinking, sleeping, and one relaxed moment near you.

## Week 2 • Rhythm (Days 8–14)

**Focus:** the daily routine becomes boringly consistent — same wake time, same meal spots, same walk route, same words.

**A win looks like:** your dog starting to anticipate the routine (waiting at the door, settling at quiet time).

## Week 3 • Trust (Days 15–21)

**Focus:** low-pressure connection — the activities on page 9. Let your dog choose to approach. Keep the routine steady.

**A win looks like:** softer body language: loose tail, resting near you, taking treats gently from your hand.

## Week 4 • Expand (Days 22–30)

**Focus:** gently widen the world — a new walk street, a calm visitor, short alone-time practice — one new thing at a time, never stacked.

**A win looks like:** recovering quickly after something new, and returning to calm.

Many adopters find the "3 days / 3 weeks / 3 months" idea a helpful frame: roughly three days to stop feeling overwhelmed, three weeks to learn the routine, three months to feel at home. Treat it as a rough guide, not a schedule your dog must meet.

# Decompression & Adjustment Schedule

What to keep small, and when to gently grow it. Move at your dog's pace — it's fine to stay on a row longer.

| DAYS  | ENVIRONMENT                                                                                         | HANDLING & CONTACT                                                                             | OUTINGS                                                                               |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1-3   | One quiet room + a safe spot (crate or bed) your dog is never bothered in. Low noise, dim evenings. | Let the dog approach you. Sit nearby, read, exist calmly. No baths, no grooming, no guests.    | Leashed potty breaks only, same door, same patch of yard or sidewalk.                 |
| 4-7   | Gradual access to more of the home, one room at a time, supervised.                                 | Hand-feed part of meals if the dog is comfortable. Start pairing your voice with good things.  | Short, quiet walks at low-traffic times. Same short route every day.                  |
| 8-14  | Normal household sounds return gradually (TV, laundry, deliveries).                                 | Begin gentle touch where your dog enjoys it (often chest or shoulder — watch their response).  | Slightly longer walks, still the familiar route. Practice calm door manners.          |
| 15-21 | Dog moves comfortably through the home. Keep the safe spot sacred.                                  | Trust activities (page 9), short grooming introductions, collar and harness handling practice. | Add one new quiet street or park edge. Observe from a distance your dog can relax at. |
| 22-30 | Practice short alone-time sessions; leave calmly, return calmly.                                    | Invite one calm visitor who ignores the dog and lets the dog decide.                           | One gentle new experience at a time — never stack new place + new people + new dogs.  |

**Rule of thumb:** if your dog stops eating, sleeping, or settling after a change — make the world smaller again for a few days. That's progress, not failure.

# Daily Rhythm Builder

Consistency beats precision: the *order* of events matters more than exact times. Fill in yours and keep it identical for the first month.

| TIME  | ANCHOR          | WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE                                                           |
|-------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| _____ | Wake & potty    | Same door, same words ("let's go out"), calm greeting — no big energy.       |
| _____ | Breakfast       | Same spot, same bowl. Quiet while eating; nobody touches the bowl.           |
| _____ | Morning walk    | Same route at the same time. Let sniffing happen — it's how dogs decompress. |
| _____ | Quiet block     | Safe-spot rest while you work or do the house. Practice being boring.        |
| _____ | Midday check-in | Potty break + two minutes of an easy trust activity (page 9).                |
| _____ | Afternoon rest  | Newly adopted dogs sleep a lot while they adjust. Let it happen.             |
| _____ | Dinner          | Same spot, same routine as breakfast.                                        |
| _____ | Evening walk    | Shorter and calmer than the morning walk. Wind the day down.                 |
| _____ | Wind-down       | Dim the lights, lower the noise, same phrase ("bedtime"), safe spot.         |

## Our words (everyone uses the same ones)

| FOR       | WE SAY | FOR               | WE SAY |
|-----------|--------|-------------------|--------|
| Going out |        | Safe spot         |        |
| Mealtime  |        | All done / settle |        |

# 30-Day Consistency Tracker

Check the anchors you kept. The goal is a mostly-full page, not a perfect one.

| DAY | AM MEAL                  | PM MEAL                  | WALK 1                   | WALK 2                   | QUIET TIME               | ONE-LINE NOTE |
|-----|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|---------------|
| 1   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 2   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 3   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 4   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 5   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 6   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 7   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 8   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 9   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 10  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 11  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 12  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 13  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 14  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 15  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 16  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 17  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 18  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 19  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 20  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 21  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 22  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 23  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 24  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 25  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 26  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 27  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 28  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 29  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |
| 30  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |               |

# Home Preparation Checklist

Twenty minutes of setup buys a much calmer first week.

---

## The safe spot

- ☐ Crate or bed in a quiet, low-traffic corner
- ☐ Blanket that will smell like this home
- ☐ Water within reach
- ☐ House rule: nobody bothers the dog here — ever

## Supplies ready

- ☐ Food (ask the rescue what the dog eats now — keep it for week 1)
- ☐ Two bowls, leash, well-fitted collar or harness
- ☐ ID tag on from minute one
- ☐ Enzyme cleaner (accidents are normal)
- ☐ A few different treats and one soft toy

## Hazard sweep

- ☐ Trash secured; food off counters and low tables
- ☐ Cords, shoes, kids' toys out of reach
- ☐ Houseplants checked and moved if needed
- ☐ Gates or closed doors for off-limits rooms
- ☐ Yard/fence gaps checked; gate latches work

## Household agreement

- ☐ Everyone has read the Roadmap (page 3)
- ☐ Same words agreed (page 5)
- ☐ Responsibilities assigned (page 12)
- ☐ Agreement: calm, quiet, no crowding for week 1

**If there are kids at home:** the first-week rule that works is simple — we let the dog come to us. Sitting on the floor nearby beats reaching, chasing, or hugging.

# First Night Checklist

The first night sets the tone. Aim for uneventful.

## Arriving home

- ☐ Straight to the potty spot on leash before going inside
- ☐ Quiet walk through only the rooms the dog will use this week
- ☐ Show the safe spot and the water — then stop giving tours
- ☐ Feed a small, unhurried meal (travel nerves shrink appetites)

## The evening

- ☐ Keep visitors away tonight — the household is enough
- ☐ Sit nearby without hovering; let the dog watch the new world
- ☐ Last potty break right before bed, same door, same words

## Overnight

- ☐ Safe spot where the dog can see or hear a person, if that settles them
- ☐ Expect some whining, pacing, or restlessness — respond with calm, brief reassurance, not excitement
- ☐ Middle-of-the-night potty trip if asked: boring, quiet, straight back to bed

**Normal in week one:** not eating much, sleeping a lot, hiding, following you everywhere, or ignoring you entirely. **Call your veterinarian** about refusing all food and water beyond a day, vomiting or diarrhea that persists, or anything that worries you — that's what they're for, even in week one.



# Ten Trust-Building Activities

Low-pressure ways to become the predictable, good thing in the room. One or two a day is plenty.

| ACTIVITY             | HOW                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 • The name game    | Say the name once, cheerful and soft. Any glance your way earns a treat. Name = good things.                                   |
| 2 • Treat scatter    | Scatter a small handful in the grass or on a snuffle mat. Sniffing and foraging is naturally calming.                          |
| 3 • Sit-with-me time | Sit on the floor with a book. No talking, no reaching. Let the dog choose the distance.                                        |
| 4 • Hand target      | Offer a flat palm at nose height. A sniff or touch earns a treat. Builds an easy, consensual hello.                            |
| 5 • The slow walk    | One walk this week has no destination. The dog picks the sniffing spots; you just follow the leash.                            |
| 6 • Find it          | Toss one treat where the dog can see it land and say "find it." Confidence, one treat at a time.                               |
| 7 • Grooming hello   | One slow brush stroke where they like touch, then stop. Ending early is the point.                                             |
| 8 • Dinner puzzle    | Feed part of a meal from a food puzzle, snuffle mat, or rolled towel. Working for food is satisfying.                          |
| 9 • Watch the world  | Sit together somewhere quiet and just watch — a porch, a window, a parked car. Calm company, zero demands.                     |
| 10 • The choice test | Pause petting after a few seconds. If the dog leans in, continue. If they move away, respect it. This one teaches <i>you</i> . |

# Observation Log

When something startles, worries, or delights your dog — jot it down. Patterns you record now make conversations with your vet or trainer far more useful.

| DATE | SITUATION (WHAT WAS HAPPENING) | WHAT I NOTICED | WHAT HELPED |
|------|--------------------------------|----------------|-------------|
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |
|      |                                |                |             |

**Bring this page with you:** "he startles at X and settles with Y" is exactly the kind of note veterinarians and trainers can work with — far better than trying to remember three weeks at once.

# Questions for Your Vet & Trainer

Book the first vet visit within the first couple of weeks (sooner if the rescue advises it). Walk in with these.

## For the veterinarian

- What vaccinations and parasite prevention does this dog need, and when?
- Is the current food appropriate? How should I switch foods safely if needed?
- What's a healthy weight for this dog, and how do we get there?
- Is microchip information registered to me now?
- Anything in the rescue's medical records I should follow up on?
- What symptoms should make me call you immediately?
- When is spay/neuter appropriate, if not done?

## For a qualified trainer

- Does what I'm seeing look like normal adjustment, or should we work on it now?
- How do I build alone-time tolerance without making it worse?
- What should I do in the moment when my dog startles or freezes?
- How do I introduce new people (and other animals) at my dog's pace?
- What equipment do you recommend for walks — and what should I avoid?
- What would make you say "bring in a veterinary behavior professional"?

## Their answers / my notes

---

---

---

---

---

---

# Household Rules & Responsibilities

Dogs relax faster when every human is predictable in the same way. Decide together, write it down, stick to it for 30 days.

## House rules (circle YES or NO — no "sometimes" for the first month)

|                       |          |                               |          |
|-----------------------|----------|-------------------------------|----------|
| Allowed on the couch? | YES / NO | Allowed in bedrooms?          | YES / NO |
| Fed from the table?   | YES / NO | Allowed to greet at the door? | YES / NO |

## Who does what

| JOB                                 | NAME | BACKUP |
|-------------------------------------|------|--------|
| Morning feed + walk                 |      |        |
| Evening feed + walk                 |      |        |
| Midday check-in / potty             |      |        |
| Training minutes + trust activities |      |        |
| Vet visits + records                |      |        |
| Weekly tracker review (page 13)     |      |        |

**The one rule that isn't optional:** the safe spot is sacred. When the dog is on their bed or in their crate, they're off duty — no petting, no calling, no kids. That single rule builds more trust than any trick.

# Weekly Progress Tracker

Five minutes at the end of each week. Progress with a rescue is measured in small, quiet moments.



|        | THIS WEEK'S WIN (HOWEVER SMALL) | HARDEST MOMENT | ONE SMALL THING TO TRY NEXT WEEK |
|--------|---------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------|
| Week 1 |                                 |                |                                  |
| Week 2 |                                 |                |                                  |
| Week 3 |                                 |                |                                  |
| Week 4 |                                 |                |                                  |

## Day 30 reflection

Look back at day one. Write down three things your dog does now that they couldn't — or wouldn't — do then.

---

---

---

What does your dog love that you didn't know a month ago?

---

---

The rhythm continues past day 30 — keep the anchors, keep the safe spot sacred, and keep letting your dog choose. You've built the foundation.

# Emergency & Important Contacts

Print this page and put it on the fridge. In a stressful moment, nobody wants to search for a phone number.

| CONTACT                         | NAME / CLINIC | PHONE |
|---------------------------------|---------------|-------|
| Primary veterinarian            |               |       |
| 24-hour emergency vet           |               |       |
| Rescue / adoption organization  |               |       |
| Trainer / behavior professional |               |       |
| Pet sitter / backup person      |               |       |
| Microchip company + chip number |               |       |

**ASPCA Animal Poison Control (US):** (888) 426-4435 — 24/7 (a consultation fee may apply).

## My dog's essentials

| ITEM                            | DETAILS |
|---------------------------------|---------|
| Food brand + daily amount       |         |
| Medications + schedule          |         |
| Known sensitivities / allergies |         |
| Words this dog knows            |         |

# Disclaimer & About

---

**Please read:** The First 30 Days Kit is an educational and organizational resource for new rescue-dog adopters. It is not veterinary care, medical advice, or professional behavior treatment, and it does not guarantee any specific behavioral outcome — every dog's history and pace are different. Always consult a licensed veterinarian for health concerns and a qualified trainer or veterinary behavior professional for concerning behavior, especially anything involving fear, aggression, or safety. If a dog ever makes you feel unsafe, contact a professional before continuing any plan — including this one.

## About Tyson's Time

Tyson is a real rescue. His first month home wasn't about training — it was about safety, patience, and a rhythm repeated every single day. This kit is the plan his family wishes they'd had on day one, organized so yours starts calmer than theirs did.

## Support

Questions about your order or the kit? Message [\*\*@tysonstime\*\*](#) on Instagram — replies come from the humans behind the account.

© 2026 Tyson's Time. For personal household use — please don't redistribute or resell. Thank you for adopting.